

ADVERTISEMENT

Increases for DC's 'Give SNAP a Raise' legislation go into effect

by Rebecca Turco
Fri, February 23, 2024 at 6:11 PM
Updated Fri, February 23, 2024 at 7:49 PM

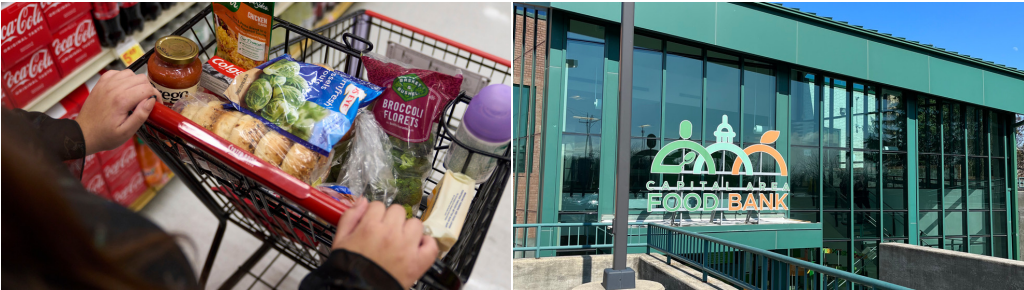


53°
LIVE

1

00:00

02:33



7News spoke toSNAP recipient Felicia Minick. (7News)

4

VIEW ALL PHOTOS



TOPICS: [SNAP](#) [BENEFITS](#) [INCREASE](#) [DHS](#) [DC](#) [LEGISLATION](#) [RECIPIENTS](#) [COUNCIL](#)

WASHINGTON (7News) — Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) recipients in the District of Columbia started receiving added benefits Friday as part of the D.C. Council's [Give SNAP a Raise legislation](#).

The Department of Human Services (DHS) is issuing retroactive payments on a rolling basis for January and February's SNAP increase directly onto each customer's EBT card before 11:59 p.m. Friday, according to a DHS spokesperson. Then starting in March, the increase will be automatically included with regular SNAP benefits through the end of the fiscal year in September.

READ | [DC Department of Human Services moving forward with increase in SNAP benefits](#)

ADVERTISEMENT

The Bowser administration initially denied the nearly \$40 million increase the D.C. Council had signed off on, citing budget shortfalls. Then, the administration [reversed course](#) at the beginning of the year after weeks of back-and-forth and threats of two potential lawsuits.

SNAP recipient Felicia Minick is grateful for the increase but wishes it was more and feels it shouldn't have taken convincing. As a senior citizen and as a SNAP recipient, she feels overlooked.

"The older you get, they write you off," Minick told 7News. "It makes me angry because I feel like anybody for real is like one step away from it. You don't know what can happen in your life. You can fall, break your leg, anything could happen and then you might need that help."

Capital Area Food Bank CEO Radaha Muthiah is praising the raise, calling it necessary at a time when more people are using the food bank than pre-pandemic.



Friday, Sept. 17, 2021, Capital Area Food Bank is working to distribute food to those who need it. (John Gonzales/7News)

"Having any support structures here, whether it's this much-needed increase in SNAP benefits or what we can provide through the food bank, are really necessary for so many of our residents who are struggling to make ends meet and to put food on the table," said Muthiah.

ALSO READ | ['I've had to ration my meals': DC SNAP recipient looks forward to increased program funding](#)

Still, Muthiah is calling for more added benefits permanently, given the area's needs.

"When people aren't worried about whether they have enough food to eat tomorrow, they can actually focus on education, on working - --and that will only drive the economic growth engine in our region, which is what we all want."

7News reached out to the mayor's office and to DHS for comment. Spokespeople for the offices both emailed statements issued last month.

"The Department of Human Services currently provides more than 83,000 DC households with SNAP benefits," the statement from the mayor's office said in part. "With significant fiscal and human resources pressures in our human services cluster, it's not prudent to increase spending on one program, especially when demand for other programs that support the same people is increasing beyond our current budget."

"Due to major budget shortfalls and workload pressures, in November I advised the Mayor that it is in best interest of residents to prioritize sustaining vital human services programs, over administering a new temporary local SNAP supplement," DHS Director Laura Zeilinger said in a statement from January 3 announcing the implementation of the increased benefits. "While fiscal and administrative pressures still exist, this evening I advised the Mayor that DHS will make this program work while we attempt to solve ongoing challenges."

MORE TO EXPLORE

11 charged with malicious wounding by mob after woman dies in Virginia shooting

Ordinary annuity vs. annuity due: The small difference that affects its value

— — —

Middle school teacher that repeatedly raped teen killed in jail by known murderer: cops

SPONSORED CONTENT

by Taboola

Costco Shoppers Say This Fat-Burning Patch Triggers Weight Loss "Unlike Any Other"

Health Advice Today | SPONSORED

1975 - 2025: Junie’s Retiring and Her Bags are a Bargain!

Junie Boutique | SPONSORED

0% Interest on Balance Transfers For Nearly 2 Years

CardCritics | SPONSORED

Conversation

Your voice matters. Discussions are moderated for civility. See our [guidelines](#).

Be the first to comment...



No one seems to have shared their thoughts on this topic yet

Leave a comment so your voice will be heard first.

ADVERTISEMENT

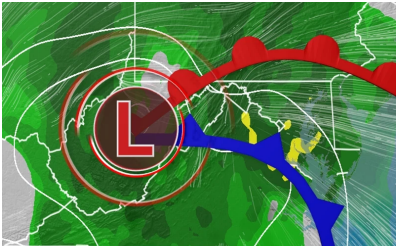
TRENDING



Spanberger declines: Earle-Sears solo in 7News Virginia Governor Forum Tuesday



Middle school teacher that repeatedly raped teen is killed in jail by known murderer: cops



STORM ALERT: DC area braces for heavy rain, wind and thunder through Thursday morning



Senate fails again to pass bi federal workers as shutdown day 29

ADVERTISEMENT



ACCESSIBILITY

Sign up for our newsletter

Stay informed. When you sign up you will receive our top local news stories delivered to your inbox.

johnndoe@gmail.com



Headlines
Newsletter



Weather
Newsletter



By Signing up, I acknowledge I have read and agree to the **Terms & Conditions** and the **Privacy Policy**

Sign Up

Download Our Mobile Apps:

- Terms & Conditions
- Copyright Notices
- EEO Public File Report
- FCC Info
- FCC Applications
- Public File Assistance
- Contact WJLA
- Submit Tip
- WJLA News Team
- Careers
- Contests
- Maryland Political Ad Disclosures – Ad Networks

- News
- Weather
- Health
- Sports
- Contests
- Game Center

- Privacy Policy
- Cookie Policy
- Do Not Sell or Share
- Cookie Preferences

© 2025 Sinclair, Inc.